

“The Name Is Connected. Dr Connected”

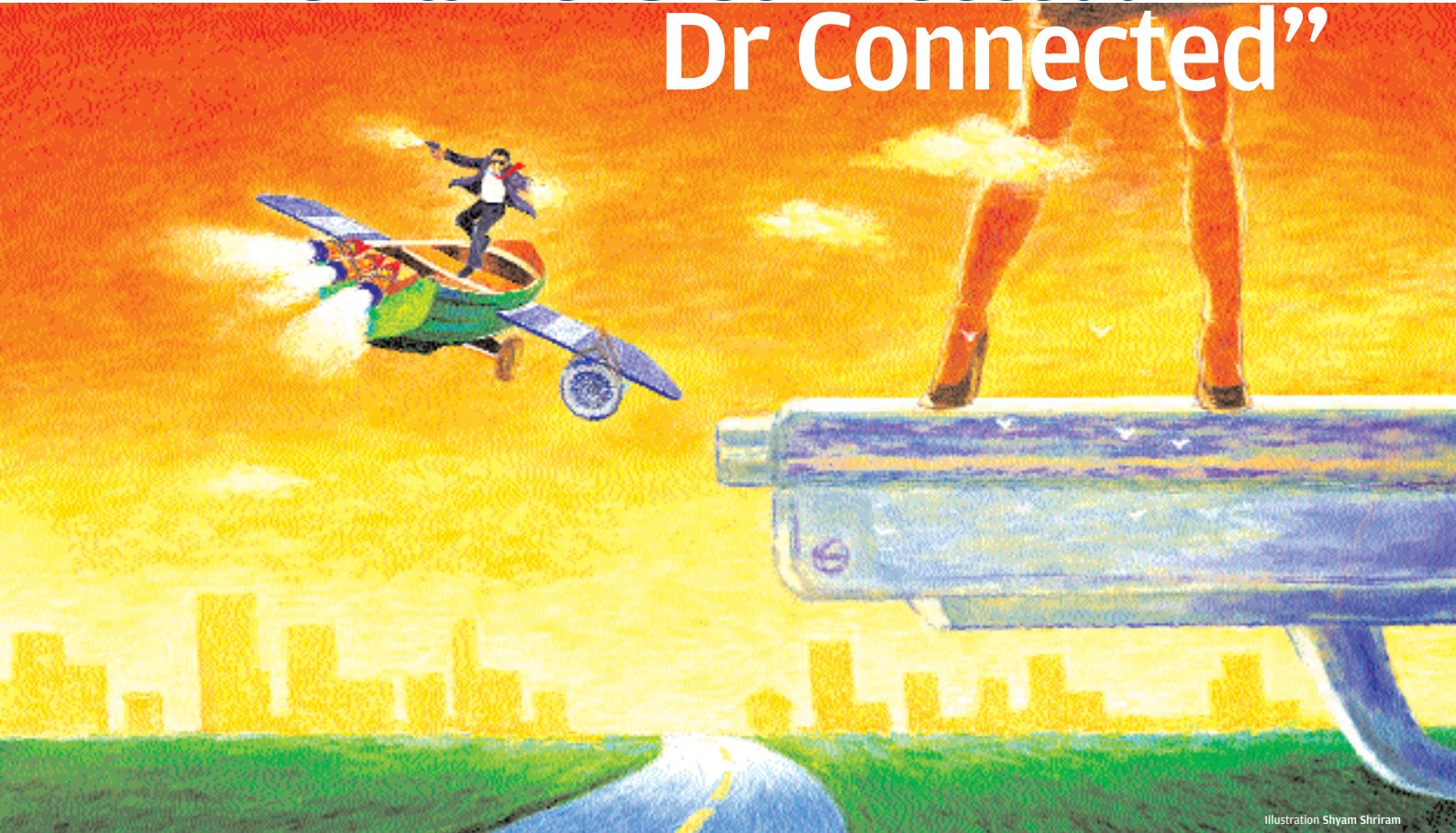


Illustration Shyam Shriram

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Varun Dubey

James Bond is the flamboyant secret agent who almost always seems to be able to dodge certain death, and always manages to find time off from saving the world to romance some of the most beautiful women on the planet! But the women, the death-defying close shaves, or the martinis—shaken, not stirred—are not the only things that constitute Bond’s aura.

Most of us salivate over the gadgets he uses, perhaps even more than we do over the women in his company. That’s where Bond fits into this special issue that celebrates convergence: many Bond gadgets reek of convergence. They’re smart, they’re multi-functional, and they talk to other gadgets. The makers of the Bond movies do seem to have put some effort into envisaging a converged world—although, of course, it was necessary that only Bond, and no one else, had the gadgets!

We plunge into the wonderland of Bond’s gadgetry, and analyse what is possible in the real world and what will remain in the reel world. We’ve rated all gadgets by a ‘Coolness Quotient’ based on how much we’d love to own one of them, and also a ‘Plausibility’ score, based on how likely it is that such gadgets can be made available. Scores are out of five.

Gadget: Briefcase

Movie: From Russia With Love

This was the first gadget the Quartermaster—or Q—gave James Bond. The briefcase held an AR7 foldable sniper rifle, 40 rounds of ammo, a tear-gas cartridge disguised as a tin of talcum powder, some money in the form of 50 gold sovereigns, and concealed throwing knives.

Plausible?

Yes, but we need to ask: with all that equipment inside, how did Bond manage to carry it around? Ten on ten for Q’s packing skills—but we’ve got to subtract a few for the sheer craziness of lugging around something so heavy and trying to save the world while you’re at it!

Coolness Quotient: 2.75

Plausibility: 4.5

Gadget: Mini Breather

Movies: Thunderball, Die Another Day

This gadget, slightly larger than a pen, allowed Bond to breathe underwater for about four minutes.

Plausible?

This is one of Bond’s gadgets that fall in the ‘fantastic’ category. To get to hard facts today, a four-litre scuba tank will give you 30 to 35 minutes of breathing air,